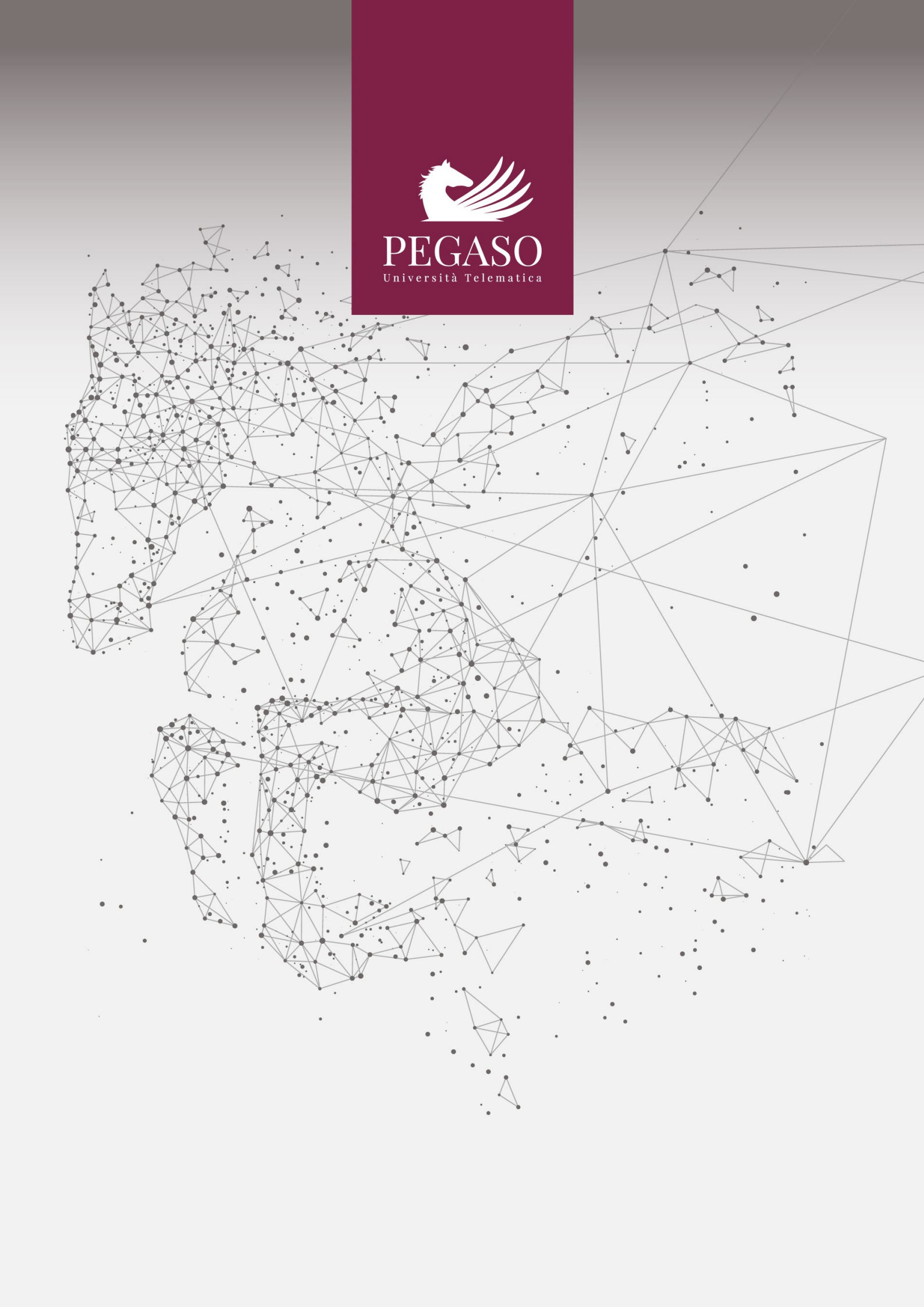

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1. Reported Speech

1. This is when we report something that has been said or written. If the report is after the time the thing was said or written, the verb form generally changes as follows:

Direct speech	**Reported speech**
present simple/continuous	past simple/continuous
“I like your shoes, Kate,” said Jack.	Jack said (that) he liked Kate's shoes.
past simple/continuous	past simple/continuous or past perfect simple/continuous
“I saw them advertised on TV,” said Kate.	Kate said (that) she saw/had seen them advertised on TV.
present perfect simple/ continuous	past perfect simple/ continuous
“I’ve bought a hat,” Helen told me.	Helen told me (that) she had bought a hat.
will	would
“I'll take you there if you want,” she said.	She said (that) she would take me there if I wanted.
must (obligation)	had to
"You must buy a ticket, he said.	He said (that) we had to buy a ticket.
can	could
I can speak Spanish, said Mel.	Mel said (that) he could speak

2. The verb form does not need to change when

a. the situation being reported is unchanged.

'Bananas are good for energy’, said the doctor.

The doctor told us that bananas are good for energy.

The castle is 800 years old, said the guide.

The guide told us that the castle is 800 years old.

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b. the thing reported contains the modals would, could, might, ought to and should or must for logical deduction.

I ought to buy a new car, she said.

She said she ought to buy a new car.

I think he must be coming, she said.

She said she thought he must be coming.

c. the thing being reported contains the past perfect.

'He had already been given a prize,' she said.

She said he had already been given a prize.

Other changes that occur in reported speech are shown in the table below:

Direct speech	**Reported speech**
tomorrow	the next day, the day after, the following day
yesterday	the day before, the previous day
last week	the week before
here	there
this morning	that morning
today	that day
next Friday	the following Friday
ago	before

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2. Reporting Sentences by Type

Reported statements:

verb (+ that) + clause

'He works in television, she said.

She said (that) he worked in television.

I took the money, she admitted.

She admitted (that) she had taken the money.

Reported questions:

1. **Reported yes/no questions**

When there is no question word in the direct speech question, we use if/whether. Word order is the same as in the statement. The verb tense and other changes are the same as for other types of reported speech.

'Could I borrow your bike?' she asked.

She asked if/whether she could borrow my bike.

2. **Reported wh- questions**

The wh-word is followed by statement word order (subject followed by verb). All tense and other changes are the same as for other types of reported speech.

Why did you leave that job?' she asked him.

She asked him why he had left that job.

"Where is the swimming pool?' he asked her.

He asked her where the swimming pool was.

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Reported imperatives:

verb + object + infinitive with to

‘Please open your suitcase’, said the customs official.

The customs official asked me to open my suitcase.

'Don't walk on the grass!" said the official.

The official told them not to walk on the grass.

Reported recommendations:

recommend + -ing

recommend (that) + clause

“I'd buy the red coat,” my friend said.

My friend recommended buying/(that) | buy/bought the red coat.

suggest +-ing

suggest + (that)+ clause

'Let's pay half each, she said.

She suggested paying half each.

She suggested that we pay half each.

Watch out! We can't say:

She suggested to pay/suggested us to pay half each. (Incorrect)

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3. Reporting Verbs

Reporting verbs

1. verb + infinitive

agree, decide, offer, promise, refuse, threaten

We agreed to go to the meeting.

2. verb + object + infinitive

advise, beg, encourage, invite, persuade, remind, tell, warn

She asked me to tell the truth.

3. verb (+ that) + clause

accept, admit, claim, explain, recommend, say, suggest

She says (that) we should be repaid the money.

4. verb + object (+ that) + clause

promise, remind, tell, warn

He told us (that) he would be on time.

5. verb + -ing

admit, deny, recommend, suggest

He admitted taking the money.

6. verb + preposition + -ing

apologize for, insist on

She apologized for being late.

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7. verb + object + preposition + -ing

accuse (of), blame (for), congratulate (on), discourage (from)

She discouraged me from going in for the competition.

8. verb + wh- word + infinitive

describe, explain, know, wonder

She explained what to do.

9. verb + object + wh-word + infinitive with **to**

ask, remind, tell

They told us who to talk to.[1]

EXERCISES

Change this direct speech into reported speech.

1. "He works in a bank

She said that

2. "We went out last night"

She told me that

3. "I'm coming!"

She said that

4. "I was waiting for the bus when he arrived"

She told me

5. "I'd never been there before"

She said that

6. "I didn't go to the party"

She told me

7. "Lucy will come later"

She said

8. "He hasn't eaten breakfast"

[1] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (173-174)

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She told me

9. "I can help you tomorrow"

She said

10. "You should go to bed early"

She told me

There are mistakes in some of the sentences below. Find and correct the mistakes and tick the sentences that are correct.

11. Joyce asked me whether I will finish the report by Friday.

12. Charles told that he would meet us at the airport.

13. Harry offered giving me a ride to the station.

14. Tom reminded me to call the hotel to cancel the reservation.

15. The supervisor accused me using the internet at work.

16. We warned him to avoid the traffic jam in Top Street.

17. Stephanie suggested us to take the bus because the trains were running late.

18. Jane explained that the computer had crashed so emails weren't getting through.

19. Peter refused apologizing to Kate.

20. Sara denied to write the bad report

Change these direct questions into reported speech:

21. "Where is he?"

She asked me

22. "What are you doing?"

She asked me

23. "Why did you go out last night?"

She asked me

24. "Who was that beautiful woman?"

She asked me

25. "How is your mother?"

She asked me

EXERCISE ANSWER KEY

1. She said (that) he worked in a bank.

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2. She told me (that) they went (had gone) out last night (the night before).

3. She said (that) she was coming.

4. She told me (that) she had been waiting for the bus when he arrived.

5. She said (that) she had never been there before.

6. She told me (that) she didn't go (hadn't gone) to the party.

7. She said (that) Lucy would come later.

8. She told me (that) he hadn't eaten breakfast.

9. She said (that) she could help me tomorrow.

10. She told me (that) I should go to bed.

11. Joyce asked me whether I would finish the report by Friday.

12. Charles said that he would meet us at the airport.

13. Harry offered to give me a ride to the station.

14. Correct

15. The supervisor accused me of using the Internet at work.

16. Correct

17. Stephanie suggested that we take the bus because the trains were running late/ Stephanie suggested taking the bus because the trains were running late.

18. Correct

19. Peter refused to apologize to Kate.

20. Sara denied writing the bad report.

21. She asked me where he was.

22. She asked me what I was doing.

23. She asked me why I went out last night.

24. She asked me who that beautiful woman was.

25. She asked me how my mother was.

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Bibliografia

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